

ANTHRO2A TA Section

Fall 2026

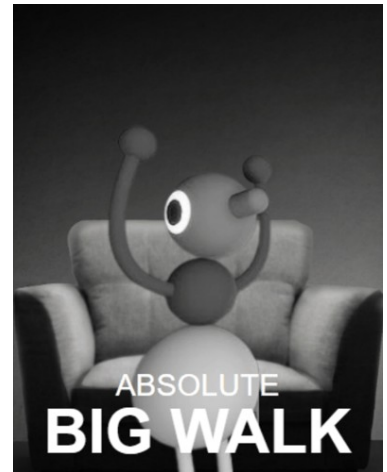
Valerie Olson

Eric Gu

Wednesdays 1-1:50 and 2-2:50 PM

About Me

- 3rd Year PhD Student in Anthropology
- Studying how social media influencers create political content between China, Taiwan, and the US
 - What does this have anything to do with anthropology? Hopefully you will know by the end of this course...
- Hobbies: Cooking, mushroom foraging, TTRPGs (DnD), riichi mahjong
- Recently playing: Big Walk



TA Sections

- MANDATORY
- Graded attendance
- Graded assignments
- Prep for exams
- www.ecgu.github.io
 - Slides from these TA sections will be uploaded here

TA Sections (Cont.)

- 1 free pass for TA section attendance
- Any more and you MUST send an email:
 - Must be titled “ANTH2A Fall 2026 – Absence Request for Teaching Section on [DATE (MM/DD/YYYY)]”
 - Must have a doctor’s note or equivalent letter from an institution
 - If not, I WILL disregard it

TA Sections (Cont.)

ta Absence - 12/2 - of my absence > beforehand. Please let me know if there is any way to review the > information discussed in today's	
[Redacted]	- Subject: Absence Good afternoon, I was wondering if the final ... - Subject: Absence Of course, thank you! Unfortunately I do not ...
ta Absence from [Redacted], I will be absent from class on November 20th as I will be out of town attending a conference. Bes	
[Redacted]	- Subject: Absence today Sorry to hear that, appreciate the consi...
[Redacted]	- Subject: Absence today Good Morning Professor [Redacted]
[Redacted]	Subject: Absent This Week No I appreciate your well wishes a...
ta Absence - Good morning! I wanted to let you know that I am feeling unwell today. My throat hurts and I don'	
[Redacted]	subject: Absence due to Sickness Hi Professor, I hope you are well!...
[Redacted]	- Subject: Absence Good morning, Please excuse my absence to...
ta Missing Class today [Redacted] - that my absence will be counted as unexcused. I wanted to inform you. Have a great rest of your day. Best regards,	
ta [Redacted]	just sent you a message in Canvas. - of my absence. I deeply value your class and do not wa...
ta Absence on 10/21 - will be absent from class on Tuesday (10/21) due to an internship presentation I'll be attending. I'll make sure	[Redacted]
[Redacted]	- /16 Absence [Redacted] Hi Eric, I hope you're doing well. I j...
ta Re: Missing Assignments - have been absent from dying sick all > week. I apologize for my abrupt absence. > I have just "remembered"	
ta [Redacted]	- Neither your absence in class nor the lateness will impact your ...

Office hours

- One-on-one questions about the course
- Email me **THREE DAYS BEFOREHAND**
- And more!
 - Study tips
 - Note-taking, test taking, essay writing, etc
 - Advice on navigating college
 - Financial, logistical, housing, academic issues etc
 - But keep in mind: I am a mandated reporter
 - Grad school/professional tips
 - Resume building
 - Advice when interacting with professors
 - You are a student at a large, successful public university: take advantage of the resources you have!

Exam Format

- Digital, figure out LockDown!
- Multiple choice questions
- Topics highlighted in texture
 - Listening to lectures is key; questions will reference things only mentioned in class

Quiz Questions Example (1)

- Teaching sections in this course will be graded on attendance
 - True
 - False

Quiz Questions Example (1)

- Teaching sections in this course will be graded on attendance
 - True
 - False



Quiz Questions Example (2)

- Which of the following is one of the four subfields of anthropology?
 - Genetic Anthropology
 - Archaeology
 - Economic Anthropology
 - Psychology
 - None of the Above

Quiz Questions Example (2)

- Which of the following is one of the four subfields of anthropology?
 - Genetic Anthropology
 - Archaeology
 - Economic Anthropology
 - Psychology
 - None of the Above

Quiz Questions Example (3)

- The location of the first _____ no longer exists, but the _____ is still stored in the back lot of the headquarters in Irvine, California.
 - Human; spaceship
 - MacDonalds; KFC
 - Eric Gu; body
 - Taco Bell; building

Quiz Questions Example (3)

- The location of the first _____ no longer exists, but the _____ is still stored in the back lot of the headquarters in Irvine, California.
 - Human; spaceship
 - MacDonalds; KFC
 - Eric Gu; body
 - Taco Bell; building



Quiz Questions Common Mistakes

- Read the question carefully: is or is NOT?
- Remember exact terms (political anthropology versus social anthropology)
- Remember how terms relate to each other (economic anthropology is a subfield, but not of the big four)
- Be wary of “all/none of the above”
- Don’t waste too much time
 - Eliminate answers through common sense

AI?

- All of my assignments FORBID any use of LLMs
- There will come a time when you must figure out how to express your thoughts on your own
 - Writing something changes what you originally plan to say in your mind; this is a good thing!
- This is the time to practice that
- I will not grade you on your spelling and grammar
- I will revoke your grade based on my own vibes.

How can I tell if its AI

- What it looks like on your end:

wahh wahh im sorry|

Dear Eric,

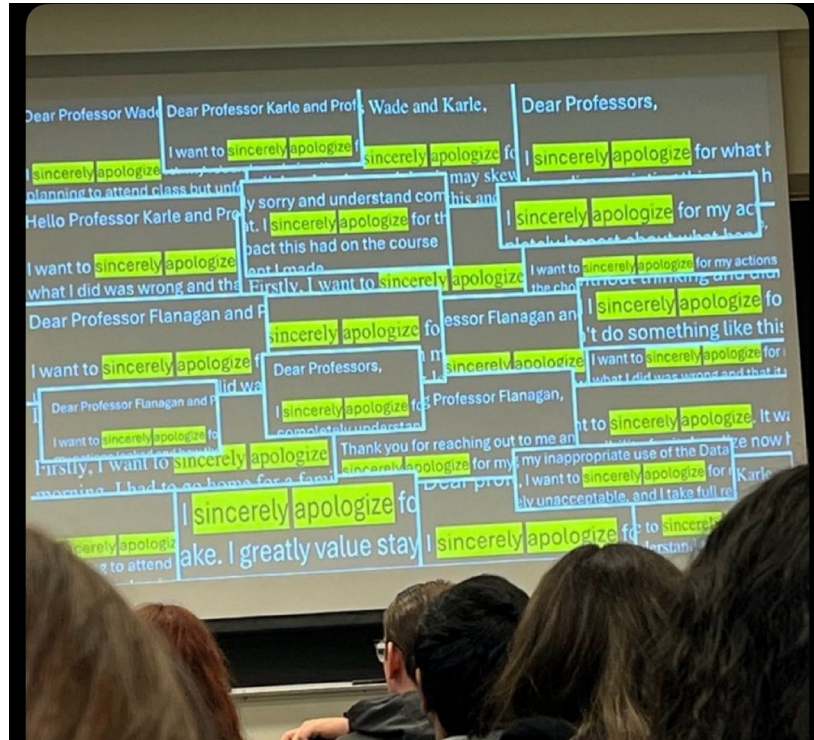
I hope this email finds you well. I am writing to offer my sincerest apologies for using AI in an assignment when I was explicitly told not to.

I understand that I betrayed your trust, and I take full responsibility for my actions. Please know that this was not intentional, and I deeply regret any inconvenience it may have caused you.

Moving forward, I am committed to writing the assignments on my own. This course is of the utmost importance to me, and I am dedicated to ensuring

How can I tell if its AI

- What it looks like on my end:



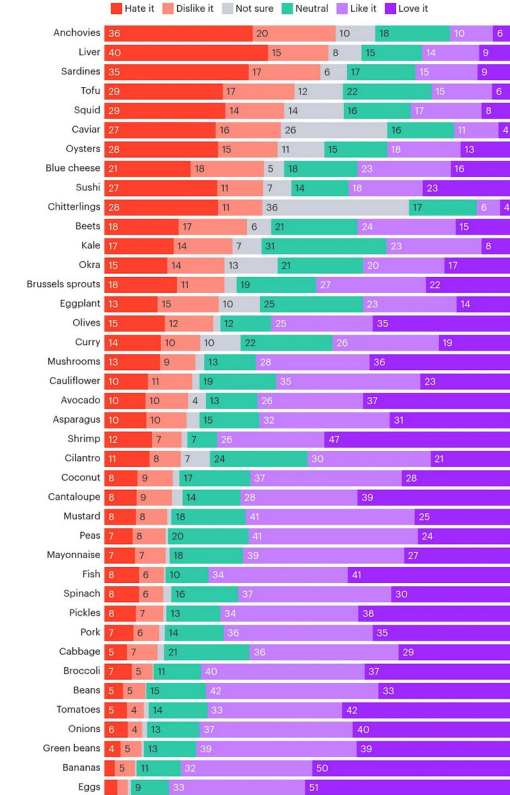
My brain is like a chatgpt trained on the big data of ai-written student assignments

About You

- Talk to the person next to you and introduce each other
- Name
- Where are you from?
- Year
- Major
- Favorite food or
- MOST HATED FOOD

The most hated foods in America

How do you feel about the following types of food? (% of U.S. adult citizens)



Note: Foods included in the survey were based on open-ended responses asking Americans which foods they hate.

YouGov

July 24 - 27, 2025